TST PREP

Practice Test #2

FOR THE
TOEFL® TEST
-2026-

Practice Test #2

For the TOEFL® Reading Section (advanced)

The TOEFL Reading Section:
Directions

In the reading section, you will answer 35-48 questions to demonstrate how well you understand academic and non-academic texts in English. There are three types of tasks.

Type of Task	Description
Complete the Words	Fill in the missing letters in a paragraph.
Read in Daily Life	Answer questions about everyday reading material.
Read an Academic Passage	Answer questions about academic passages.

Module 1

Fill in the missing letters in the paragraph.

The water cycle describes how water constantly moves through Earth's air, land, and oceans. Wh _ _ the s _ _ warms the sur _ _ _ _ , some wa _ _ _ changes in _ _ vapor and ri _ _ _ . That va _ _ _ cools i _ the s _ _ and fo _ _ _ clouds that eventually release rain or snow. The water then returns to rivers and lakes before starting the cycle again. This natural process keeps fresh water available and helps control the planet's temperature. Scientists study it to understand and make predictions about the weather and climate.

Read an email.

Subject:	Writing Workshop Information

Dear Ms. Hernandez,

Thank you for enrolling in our writing workshop. Your participation is confirmed once payment is received by October 2. Please note that late payments will cancel your registration automatically. We look forward to having you in class.

Best Regards,
Luis Fernandez

11. What must happen before Ms. Hernandez's registration is finalized?

- **a.** The instructor must confirm the workshop topic.
- **b.** The payment must be received by October 2.
- **c.** She must submit a writing sample.
- **d.** The workshop schedule must be published.

12. Which of the following is NOT true according to the message?

- **a.** Payment is required to confirm registration.
- **b.** Late payments will lead to cancellation.
- **c.** The workshop starts on October 2.
- **d.** The sender expects Ms. Hernandez to attend.

Read an announcement.

The university's Student Center will undergo renovations beginning Monday, March 10. During the first phase, the main lobby and cafeteria will be closed for approximately four weeks. Food services will operate temporarily in Building B, Room 205, where students can purchase snacks, drinks, and light meals.

All club meetings and student organization events scheduled in the Student Center should be moved to alternate spaces. Reservations can be made through the Facilities Office.

The renovations will include upgraded lighting, energy-efficient air systems, and improved accessibility for all visitors. We appreciate your patience as we work to make the Student Center a more comfortable and inclusive space for everyone.

13. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To invite students to attend an opening ceremony
- **b.** To request volunteers for the renovation project to improve accessibility
- **c.** To provide details about the reservation process for alternate spaces
- **d.** To inform students about temporary changes caused by construction

14. Where can students buy food while the cafeteria is closed?

- **a.** In the Student Center lobby
- **b.** In Building B, Room 205
- **c.** In the main lobby
- **d.** In the dormitory lounge

15. What can be inferred about the renovated Student Center?

- **a.** It will be more environmentally friendly than before.
- **b.** It will no longer allow public events.
- **c.** It will reduce the number of available study spaces.
- **d.** It will no longer be available for club meetings and events

Arctic Sea Ice and Global Climate

Arctic sea ice forms when ocean water freezes during winter and partially melts each summer. Over the past few decades, satellite observations have revealed a consistent decline in both the area and thickness of this ice. Scientists consider these measurements an important indicator of global climate change.

When sea ice melts, the darker ocean surface beneath it absorbs more sunlight, leading to additional warming—a process known as the ice-albedo feedback. This effect not only accelerates melting but also influences weather patterns far beyond the Arctic. Researchers have linked declining ice cover to shifts in jet streams and more extreme weather in temperate regions.

Melting sea ice also affects marine life. Species such as polar bears and seals depend on stable ice platforms for hunting and breeding. As these platforms disappear, animals must travel farther to find food, and survival rates drop. Indigenous communities that rely on sea ice for travel and hunting face similar challenges as their traditional routes become unsafe.

Scientists are monitoring seasonal cycles to understand how long-term warming might alter global ocean currents. Small changes in these currents can disrupt ecosystems and even affect rainfall patterns worldwide.

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16. The word "indicator" in the passage is closest in meaning to

- **a.** reaction
- **b.** barrier
- **c.** replacement
- **d.** sign

17. According to the passage, what happens when the ocean surface is exposed?

- **a.** It reflects more sunlight back into space.
- **b.** It absorbs more heat, leading to further warming.
- **c.** It freezes again more rapidly the next season.
- **d.** It reduces the amount of global precipitation.

18. Why does the author mention polar bears and seals?

- **a.** To demonstrate how melting sea ice threatens Arctic wildlife
- **b.** To suggest that marine mammals adapt easily to warmer water
- **c.** To explain how scientists measure sea-ice decline
- **d.** To compare different breeding habits among Arctic species

19. Click on the sentence in paragraph 4 that explains how changes in ocean currents could have consequences globally (on test day, you can click any sentence).

- **a.** As these platforms disappear, animals must travel farther to find food, and survival rates drop.
- **b.** Indigenous communities that rely on sea ice for travel and hunting face similar challenges as their traditional routes become unsafe.
- **c.** Scientists are monitoring seasonal cycles to understand how long-term warming might alter global ocean currents.
- **d.** Small changes in these currents can disrupt ecosystems and even affect rainfall patterns worldwide.

20. What can be inferred about the ice-albedo feedback?

- **a.** It helps regulate rainfall patterns.
- **b.** It slows down the process of climate change.
- **c.** It can intensify global warming once melting begins.
- **d.** It occurs only in tropical regions.

Module 2

Fill in the missing letters in the paragraph.

Long before modern transportation, people traveled great distances to exchange goods. Tra _ _ _ _ carried us _ _ _ _ items li _ _ cloth or sa _ _ along pa _ _ _ that li _ _ _ _ villages a _ _ cities. Th _ _ _ journeys we _ _ slow but he _ _ _ _ spread new ideas and customs between cultures. Some towns grew wealthy by serving travelers and keeping the routes safe. Early trade routes not only supported business but also connected distant societies in ways that shaped human history.

The Expansion of the Printing Press

When Johannes Gutenberg introduced movable-type printing in the mid-1400s, few realized how dramatically it would reshape Europe. His invention made it possible to reproduce texts faster and at a fraction of the cost of hand-copied manuscripts. Within decades, presses appeared in dozens of cities, turning what had once been rare into something nearly commonplace.

Early printers produced religious works such as Bibles and prayer books, but soon moved on to scientific and literary texts. The spread of printed material accelerated the exchange of ideas, allowing scholars to challenge accepted beliefs. This new accessibility to knowledge fueled movements like the Renaissance and the Reformation.

Not everyone welcomed the change. Religious and political authorities worried that printing could spread dissenting views. As a result, governments introduced censorship laws, sometimes banning specific books or requiring printers to obtain official licenses. Despite these restrictions, presses continued to multiply, and literacy rates rose steadily. By the seventeenth century, printing had become central to education and public debate. The technology not only preserved information but also democratized it, laying the foundation for modern journalism and mass communication.

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31. What is the main idea of the passage?

- **a.** Gutenberg's invention transformed how information spread in Europe.
- **b.** Printing presses replaced handwritten manuscripts overnight.
- **c.** Governments supported the expansion of printing.
- **d.** Religious works were the only materials produced by early printers.

32. The word "accelerated" in the passage is closest in meaning to

- **a.** delayed
- **b.** limited
- **c.** increased
- **d.** supported

33. What can be inferred about literacy during this period?

- **a.** It improved partly because printed texts became more available.
- **b.** It declined due to widespread censorship from authority figures.
- **c.** It was limited to government officials and people in powerful positions.
- **d.** It was used mostly for religious education.

34. There are four locations in the passage marked (A), (B), (C), and (D). Where would the following sentence best fit?

This rapid spread created a network of printers who started producing what was most in demand at the time: religious texts.

(A) His invention made it possible to reproduce texts faster and at a fraction of the cost of hand-copied manuscripts. (B) Within decades, presses appeared in dozens of cities, turning what had once been rare into something nearly commonplace. (C) Early printers produced religious works such as Bibles and prayer books, but soon moved on to scientific and literary texts. (D) The spread of printed material accelerated the exchange of ideas, allowing scholars to challenge accepted beliefs.

35. All of the following are true about the impact of printing EXCEPT

a. It encouraged the exchange of knowledge among scholars.
b. It contributed to major cultural movements like the Renaissance.
c. It ended government control of information.
d. It made books more widely accessible.

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Practice Test #2

For the TOEFL® Reading Section

Answer Key

The Grading Rubric

Use the chart below to determine your score in the reading section.

The test used to be graded on a 120-point scale, with each section being worth 30 points. In the Score Estimate column on the right, you can see the old scoring criteria in parentheses.

For this particular test, there are 35 questions, each worth one point.

Raw Points	Score Estimate
34-35	6 (29-30)
32-33	5.5 (27-28)
28-31	5 (24-26)
26-27	4.5 (22-23)
21-25	4 (18-21)
14-20	3.5 (12-17)
7-13	3 (6-11)
5-6	2.5 (4-5)
3-4	2 (3)
2	1.5 (2)
0-1	1 (0-1)

Module 1: Answer Key

1-10

The water cycle describes how water constantly moves through Earth's air, land, and oceans. Wh{en} the s{un} warms the sur{face), some wa{ter} changes in{to} vapor and ri{ses}. That va{por} cools i{n} the s{ky} and fo{rms} clouds that eventually release rain or snow. The water then returns to rivers and lakes before starting the cycle again. This natural process keeps fresh water available and helps control the planet's temperature. Scientists study it to understand and make predictions about the weather and climate.

11. B
B is correct because the email clearly states, *"Your participation is confirmed once payment is received by October 2."* This means that the payment must be received by October 2 for Ms. Hernandez's registration to be finalized. A is incorrect because the message does not mention the instructor confirming the topic. C is incorrect because there is no mention of submitting a writing sample. D is incorrect because the workshop schedule is not referenced as a condition for registration.

12. C
C is correct because the email never states that the workshop starts on October 2; that date only refers to the payment deadline. A and B are true since payment is required to confirm registration, and late payments cause cancellation. D is also true because the closing line, *"We look forward to having you in class,"* shows that the sender expects Ms. Hernandez to attend.

13. D
D is correct because the announcement's purpose is to inform students about temporary changes caused by construction. It explains that renovations will begin on March 10, lists areas that will be closed, and provides temporary arrangements. A is incorrect because there is no mention of an opening ceremony. B is incorrect because the announcement does not request volunteers. C is incorrect because while reservations are mentioned, they are only one small part of the message, not the main purpose.

14. B
B is correct because the announcement states, *"Food services will operate temporarily in Building B, Room 205, where students can purchase snacks, drinks, and light meals."* This clearly identifies Building B, Room 205 as the temporary location for food purchases. A and C are incorrect because the main lobby and cafeteria will be closed. D is incorrect because the dormitory lounge is never mentioned.

15. A
A is correct because the announcement mentions *"upgraded lighting"* and *"energy-efficient air systems,"* which suggests that the renovated Student Center will be more environmentally friendly than before. B and D are incorrect because the announcement says club meetings and events should be temporarily moved, implying they will return after renovations. C is incorrect because there is no mention of reducing study spaces.

16. D
D is correct because "indicator" means sign or signal. The passage says, *"Scientists consider these measurements an important indicator of global climate change,"* meaning the data are a sign of change. A, B, and C do not fit the context—"reaction," "barrier," and "replacement" are unrelated to evidence or signs.

17. B
B is correct because the passage explains that when sea ice melts, the dark ocean surface absorbs more sunlight, leading to additional warming. A is incorrect because the opposite happens—the ocean absorbs more sunlight, not reflects it. C is incorrect because faster refreezing is not mentioned. D is incorrect because there is no mention of precipitation changes at this stage.

18. A
A is correct because the author mentions polar bears and seals to show how melting sea ice threatens Arctic wildlife. The passage states these animals rely on ice for hunting and breeding, and their survival is affected as it disappears. B is incorrect because the passage describes difficulty adapting, not ease. C is incorrect because scientists measuring ice decline is not the purpose of mentioning animals. D is incorrect because breeding comparisons are not made.

19. D
D is correct because this sentence directly explains how changes in ocean currents could have worldwide consequences. It highlights global impacts on ecosystems and rainfall patterns, fulfilling the question requirement.

20. C
C is correct because the passage says that when sea ice melts, the ocean absorbs more sunlight, leading to additional warming—a self-reinforcing cycle known as the ice-albedo feedback. This means it can intensify global warming once melting begins. A is incorrect because rainfall regulation is mentioned in a different context. B is incorrect because the process speeds up, not slows down, climate change. D is incorrect because it occurs in polar regions, not tropical ones.

Module 2: Answer Key

21-30

Long before modern transportation, people traveled great distances to exchange goods. Tra{ders} carried us{eful} items li{ke} cloth or sa{lt} along pa{ths} that li{nked} villages a{nd} cities. Th{ese} journeys we{re} slow but he{lped} spread new ideas and customs between cultures. Some towns grew wealthy by serving travelers and keeping the routes safe. Early trade routes not only supported business but also connected distant societies in ways that shaped human history.

31. A
A is correct because the passage emphasizes how Gutenberg's invention transformed the spread of information across Europe. The first paragraph introduces printing as a technology that "reshaped Europe" by making books cheaper and faster to produce, while later paragraphs describe its influence on religion, science, and public debate. B is incorrect because the passage does not suggest handwritten manuscripts disappeared "overnight." C is incorrect because governments often restricted printing through censorship, not fully supported it. D is incorrect because although early printers began with religious works, they soon expanded to scientific and literary texts.

32. C
C is correct because "accelerated" means increased in speed or made faster. The passage says, "The spread of printed material accelerated the exchange of ideas," meaning the exchange of ideas increased or quickened. A, B, and D are incorrect because "delayed," "limited," and "supported" do not fit the context of something that moved more rapidly.

33. A
A is correct because the final paragraph states that literacy rates rose steadily as printing spread and books became more widely available. Therefore, it can be inferred that literacy improved partly because printed texts were more accessible. B is incorrect because censorship was mentioned, but literacy still increased. C is incorrect because reading was not limited to officials; the text says printing "democratized" information. D is incorrect because the passage explicitly says printers also produced scientific and literary texts, not only religious material.

34. C
C is correct because the sentence *"This rapid spread created a network of printers who started producing what was most in demand at the time: religious texts"* logically fits after (B), which reads, *"Within decades, presses appeared in dozens of cities, turning what had once been rare into something nearly commonplace."* This placement maintains the chronological flow from the spread of presses to the kinds of works they produced. At (A) or (B), it interrupts the introduction of printing's invention; at (D), it comes too late and would break the transition to paragraph two.

35. C

C is correct because the passage says that governments introduced censorship laws and sometimes banned books, showing that printing did not immediately end government control of information. A, B, and D are all true: printing accelerated the exchange of knowledge among scholars, fueled movements like the Renaissance and the Reformation, and made books more widely accessible to the public.

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Practice Test #2

For the TOEFL® Listening Section (advanced)

The TOEFL Listening Section:
Directions

In the listening section, you will answer 35-45 questions to demonstrate how well you understand spoken English. There are three types of tasks.

Type of Task	Description
Listen and Choose a Response	Select the best response to the question or statement.
Conversations	Answer questions about short conversations.
Announcements and Academic Talks	Answer questions about announcements and academic talks.

You WILL NOT be able to return to previous questions.

Module 1

Choose the best response.

1.

a. I made coffee yesterday.
b. The grocery store opens early.
c. I ran out of milk, too.
d. You can use one of mine.

2.

a. I think she called this morning.
b. I'll text you when I get home.
c. Your phone's on the table.
d. I already left a message.

3.

a. The table's pretty heavy.
b. Sure, I'll grab the other end.
c. Yes, I moved the chairs earlier.
d. It belongs in the corner.

4.

a. She answered all my questions after class.
b. The professor teaches on Monday mornings.
c. I'm planning to enroll in her class soon.
d. No, but I read the course syllabus.

5.

a. It usually opens at eight o'clock.
b. Most of the team was working from home.
c. The office has been repainted.
d. Yes, I noticed that yesterday.

6.

a. I completely understand.
b. It's right down the hall.
c. The afternoon went quickly.
d. I missed the last meeting.

7.

a. No, it started well after that.
b. Yes, I've seen that one.
c. No, I didn't check the time.
d. The tickets sold out quickly.

8.

a. The topic was really difficult.
b. Yes, I sent the final version this morning.
c. No, I'm meeting my group later.
d. The presentation went well.

9.

a. The lights in that room are too dim.
b. I can come by early and take care of it.
c. The screen's already in place.
d. It's an old model, I think.

10.

a. No, I don't shop there.
b. Yes, I went there yesterday.
c. It's across from the gas station.
d. It closes at ten, so we still have time.

11.

a. Yes, it was an incredible show.
b. It got moved to Saturday evening.
c. The seats are near the stage.
d. No, I wasn't invited.

12.

a. The store closes at nine.
b. It's in the car.
c. I'll pick some up.
d. I used the last of the cereal.

Listen to a conversation.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

13. Why was the woman late for work?

- **a.** She forgot to turn her phone volume back up.
- **b.** She accidentally turned off her phone alarm.
- **c.** Her alarm clock stopped working during the night.
- **d.** Her roommate woke her up later than usual.

14. What can be inferred about the woman's boss?

- **a.** The boss usually overlooks minor mistakes at work.
- **b.** The boss is frustrated that she arrived late again.
- **c.** The boss also had issues with the morning alarm.
- **d.** The boss asked her to buy a new alarm clock.

Listen to a conversation.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

15. What can be inferred about the woman?

- **a.** She has not started packing for the trip yet.
- **b.** She likes to make sure plans are confirmed before traveling.
- **c.** She is unsure whether the hotel will have enough rooms.
- **d.** She forgot to bring up travel details earlier in the week.

16. Why does the man plan to go to the store after work?

- **a.** He wants to check the store's sale on luggage.
- **b.** He still needs to buy supplies for the trip.
- **c.** He needs to return some items he bought earlier.
- **d.** He is meeting a friend there before dinner.

Listen to a conversation.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

17. What does the woman offer to do?

- **a.** Help the man jump-start his car using her cables
- **b.** Drive the man to the nearest repair shop
- **c.** Lend her car to the man for the day
- **d.** Call roadside assistance on his behalf

18. Why does the woman mention getting a new battery?

- **a.** She believes the battery cables are damaged.
- **b.** She thinks the man's car is too old to repair.
- **c.** She wants to recommend a mechanic she knows.
- **d.** The current one may be losing power repeatedly.

Listen to an announcement at a university event.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

19. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To announce repairs in the residence halls
- **b.** To introduce a recycling competition
- **c.** To promote a lecture about waste reduction
- **d.** To check the university website for updates

20. Why does the speaker mention a pizza party?

- **a.** To describe the prize for the residence hall that wins
- **b.** To thank students who helped organize the event
- **c.** To advertise a food drive happening next week
- **d.** To encourage students to attend the kickoff meeting

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

21. What are members encouraged to do before each session?

- **a.** Meet individually with the club president
- **b.** Review their assigned debate topics
- **c.** Practice speeches in front of classmates
- **d.** Update their calendars with new tournament dates

22. Why does the speaker mention rebuttals and timing?

- **a.** To help students prepare their travel arrangements
- **b.** To remind members about competition rules
- **c.** To describe the format of the regional event
- **d.** To emphasize the focus of upcoming practice sessions

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

23. What are students encouraged to do?

- **a.** Check the posted schedule for their rehearsal days
- **b.** Submit costume measurements to the director before costume fittings
- **c.** Arrive early to help with stage setup at the Black Box Theater
- **d.** Be sure to check the website for their assigned role

24. Why does the speaker mention costume fittings?

- **a.** To thank volunteers for sewing the costumes
- **b.** To explain that costumes are still being designed
- **c.** To announce that fittings will take place off-campus
- **d.** To remind students they must attend

Listen to an announcement on the university radio station.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

25. What does the announcement recommend students do?

- **a.** Bring printed copies of their essays to class
- **b.** Schedule appointments early
- **c.** Contact tutors directly by email for feedback
- **d.** Extend their availability for tutoring hours

26. Why does the speaker mention citation formatting?

- **a.** To remind students to use official university templates
- **b.** To advertise a new course on academic writing
- **c.** To give an example of the type of help tutors provide
- **d.** To explain why the Writing Center updated its policies

Listen to a talk in a biology class.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

27. What is the main focus of the talk?

- **a.** How modern agriculture has changed plant and animal evolution in dry climates
- **b.** How desert animals depend on plants for food and water to survive the harsh conditions
- **c.** How deserts form in regions with limited rainfall
- **d.** How desert plants survive extreme conditions through adaptations

28. According to the talk, how does the cactus conserve water?

- **a.** Its thick stem stores moisture while its spines reduce water loss.
- **b.** Its deep roots pull moisture from underground rivers.
- **c.** Its flat leaves reflect sunlight to stay cool.
- **d.** Its hollow interior collects dew during the night.

29. What can be inferred about life in the desert environment?

- **a.** Desert plants survive when supported by irrigation systems.
- **b.** Deserts are mostly lifeless areas with little biological activity.
- **c.** Plants have evolved complex ways to endure drought.
- **d.** The evolution of desert plants has been delayed due to harsh conditions.

30. Why does the speaker mention engineers studying desert plants?

- **a.** To suggest that engineers are finding ways to replenish natural ecosystems
- **b.** To explain how desert research benefits agricultural exports
- **c.** To describe how plants are used in renewable energy systems
- **d.** To show how plant adaptations inspire new water-saving technologies

Module 2

Choose the best response.

31.

a. There are snacks in the kitchen.
b. The meeting starts at three o'clock.
c. I'll swing by the store on my way in.
d. I left my wallet in the car.

32.

a. I've already read the report twice.
b. Yes, I printed them all this morning.
c. The copies were longer than expected.
d. On your desk, right next to the printer.

33.

a. The train station has several platforms
b. I like traveling by train more than by plane.
c. At nine thirty, but I plan to arrive early.
d. My ticket says seat number twelve.

Listen to a conversation.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

34. Why does the woman plan to visit the shelter this weekend?

- **a.** To attend an orientation session for new workers
- **b.** To adopt a pet for herself or a friend
- **c.** To learn more about what volunteering there involves
- **d.** To deliver supplies to the staff at the shelter

35. What tasks will the woman likely do at the shelter?

- **a.** Manage volunteer sign-up forms and provide directions
- **b.** Assist with fundraising events and donations
- **c.** Train animals for adoption programs
- **d.** Walk dogs and clean the play area

Listen to a conversation.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

36. Why does the woman advise the man to register soon?

- **a.** The school offers a discount for early registration.
- **b.** The registration website will close by the weekend.
- **c.** The shuttle schedule changes after the deadline.
- **d.** The most popular sessions tend to fill up quickly.

37. What will the man probably do tonight?

- **a.** Register for the conference
- **b.** Review the workshop list
- **c.** Call the event organizer to ask for more details
- **d.** Ask friends if they are also attending

Listen to a talk in a physiology class.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

38. According to the talk, what did the student experiment reveal about memory?

- **a.** Students who napped briefly learned more than those who slept fully.
- **b.** Students who stayed awake processed information faster the next day.
- **c.** Students who studied in the morning performed equally well.
- **d.** Students who slept after studying remembered more than those who stayed awake.

39. Why does the speaker mention rats navigating a maze?

- **a.** To prove that the way animals sleep impacts their performance on tests
- **b.** To demonstrate that animals sleep for shorter periods than humans
- **c.** To show that the effects of sleep occur in other species as well
- **d.** To compare animal learning with human problem-solving

40. What can be inferred about why sleep is important for learning?

- **a.** It gives students more time to review material consciously.
- **b.** It allows the brain to organize new information efficiently.
- **c.** It prevents distractions that interfere with studying.
- **d.** It replaces the need for extended practice during the day.

41. What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

- **a.** How brain imaging could help scientists treat sleep disorders
- **b.** How lifestyle changes can eliminate the need for naps
- **c.** How scientists measure the effects of caffeine on sleep
- **d.** How sleep patterns differ among various cultures

Listen to a talk in an ecology class.

NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

42. What is the main topic of the talk?

- **a.** The effect of air pollution on public health
- **b.** The impact of global warming on urban design
- **c.** The advantages of reflective roofing and green spaces
- **d.** The causes and consequences of higher temperatures in cities

43. According to the talk, why do city surfaces, such as pavement and brick, remain warm after sunset?

- **a.** They trap rising heat from buildings and vehicles between dense city structures.
- **b.** They retain solar heat absorbed during the day and release it gradually at night.
- **c.** They prevent air from circulating, which keeps ground-level temperatures higher.
- **d.** They reflect sunlight and intensify the amount of heat absorbed by nearby materials.

44. Why does the speaker mention Los Angeles in the talk?

- **a.** To explain how local governments are taking steps to end global warming
- **b.** To describe a city that suffers from air pollution
- **c.** To contrast urban and rural climate conditions
- **d.** To provide an example of how cities can reduce heat

45. What can be inferred about the relationship between city planning and climate?

- **a.** Rising temperatures are unavoidable regardless of construction choices
- **b.** Urban design decisions can significantly influence temperature conditions
- **c.** Rural communities benefit from reflective building materials more than urban areas
- **d.** Government regulation can have a positive impact on climate change

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Practice Test #2

For the TOEFL® Listening Section

Answer Key

The Grading Rubric

Use the chart below to determine your score in the listening section.

The test used to be graded on a 120-point scale, with each section being worth 30 points. In the Score Estimate column on the right, you can see the old scoring criteria in parentheses.

For this particular test, there are 45 questions, each worth one point.

Raw Points	Score Estimate
42-45	6 (28-30)
39-41	5.5 (26-27)
33-38	5 (22-25)
30-32	4.5 (20-21)
26-29	4 (17-19)
20-25	3.5 (13-16)
14-19	3 (9-12
9-13	2.5 (6-8)
5-8	2 (4-5)
3-4	1.5 (2-3)
0-2	1 (0-1)

Module 1: Answer Key

Listen and Choose #1

1. D, *You can use one of mine.*
D is correct because it fulfills the speaker's need by offering a practical solution. The other responses mention related topics like milk or stores, but don't actually help.

I'm out of coffee filters.

2. B, *I'll text you when I get home.*
B is correct because it agrees to remind the speaker later, matching the intent of the request. The other options refer to calls or messages but don't promise a reminder.

Could you remind me to call my mom later?

3. B, *Sure, I'll grab the other end.*
B is correct because it offers immediate assistance in moving the table, fitting the cooperative tone of the request. The other options are either observations or unrelated comments.

Would you help me move this table?

4. A, *She answered all my questions after class.*
A is correct because it directly addresses whether the conversation happened and adds detail about the discussion. The other responses discuss scheduling or intentions, not the actual meeting.

Did you get a chance to talk to the professor?

5. B, *Most of the team was working from home.*
B is correct because it logically explains the quiet office. The other responses provide background information or irrelevant details without answering why.

Why was the office so quiet this morning?

6. A, *I completely understand.*
A is correct because it acknowledges the speaker's statement politely and appropriately. The other responses mention unrelated details and fail to convey understanding.

I'm not available this afternoon.

7. A, *No, it started well after that.*
A is correct because it clarifies that the movie began later, addressing the timing question directly. The other options are unrelated or incomplete responses.

Didn't the movie start at seven?

8. B, *Yes, I sent the final version this morning.*
B is correct because it gives a clear yes answer and adds helpful detail. The others either describe the topic or move away from the question entirely.

Did you finish the group project?

9. B, *I can come by early and take care of it.*
B is correct because it offers to handle the setup, fulfilling the implied request for help. The other options mention conditions or equipment but don't solve the problem.

I might need help setting up the projector.

10. D, *It closes at ten, so we still have time.*
D is correct because it answers the question with a clear statement of hours and adds a reassuring comment. The others mention shopping habits or locations instead.

Isn't the grocery store open late tonight?

11. B, *It got moved to Saturday evening.*
B is correct because it provides new, relevant information correcting the speaker's assumption. The other responses talk about unrelated aspects of the concert.

Didn't you say the concert was on Friday?

12. C, *I'll pick some up.*
C is correct because it responds naturally to the speaker's observation by offering to take action. The other options describe circumstances without resolving the issue.

We're running low on milk again.

Conversation #1

13. A
The woman explains that she turned her phone volume down last night so she wouldn't wake her roommate, and never turned it back up. This clearly shows that the alarm did sound, but she couldn't hear it because the volume was too low. Option B is incorrect because she didn't forget to set the alarm. Option C doesn't fit since no alarm clock malfunctioned. Option D is wrong because the roommate never tried to wake her.

14. B
The woman says her boss "*wasn't too happy about it,*" and the man adds that she was late "*again*." This tells us the boss is frustrated that she's been late more than once. Option A is incorrect because the boss clearly does not overlook mistakes. Options C and D introduce details that never appear in the exchange.

Conversation #1 Transcript

Woman: My phone alarm didn't go off this morning, and I was late to work again.
Man: Did you forget to set it?
Woman: No, I turned the volume down last night so I wouldn't wake my roommate, and I never turned it back up.
Man: At least it's an easy fix.
Woman: Yeah, but my boss wasn't too happy about it. I need to get a real alarm clock.

Conversation #2

15. B
When the woman says she will "*double-check the hotel confirmation tonight just to be safe*," it shows she likes to make sure everything is arranged before traveling. Option A is wrong because she doesn't mention her own packing. Option C misinterprets her caution as worry about room availability. Option D doesn't apply since she never forgot any plans.

16. B
The man tells her he still needs "*sunscreen and some snacks for the drive*," meaning he's going to the store to buy last-minute trip items. Option A is irrelevant, as luggage isn't mentioned. Option C is wrong because he isn't returning anything. Option D also doesn't fit; his errand is for supplies, not a meeting.

Conversation #2 Transcript

Woman: Are you ready for the family trip this weekend?
Man: Almost. I packed most of the clothes last night, but I still need to grab a few things from the store.
Woman: What are you missing?

Man: Sunscreen and some snacks for the drive. I'll pick them up after work.
Woman: Good idea. I'll double-check the hotel confirmation tonight just to be safe.
Man: Perfect. Then we'll be all set.

Conversation #3

17. A
The woman offers, "*You can try jump-starting it with my car. I have cables in the trunk.*" This makes it clear she's willing to help him start the car using her own vehicle and jumper cables. None of the other choices match what she actually says.

18. D
After suggesting the jump-start, the woman warns, "*If it happens again soon, then you probably need a new battery*." She believes the battery may be losing power repeatedly, not that the cables are damaged or the car too old. Options A and C misrepresent her comments.

Conversation #3 Transcript

Man: My car won't start again. I think the battery's dead.
Woman: Did you leave the lights on overnight?
Man: I don't remember doing that, but I must have. I was unloading groceries, and I guess I forgot to double-check.
Woman: You can try jump-starting it with my car. I have cables in the trunk.
Man: That'd be great. I'll grab them now.
Woman: But if it happens again soon, then you probably need a new battery.

Announcement #1

19. B
The speaker announces the start of a "*campus recycling challenge*" in which residence halls will compete to collect recyclable materials. The entire message focuses on introducing this event, making option B correct. Option A is unrelated since no repairs are mentioned. Option C sounds plausible but refers to a lecture, not a competition. Option D repeats part of the announcement but misses the main purpose—it's a supporting detail, not the focus.

20. A
The pizza party is described as a reward for the residence hall that wins the challenge. It's included to show the prize, not to thank organizers or promote another event. Option B is incorrect because the speaker never mentions volunteers. Options C and D both describe different kinds of events that aren't part of the announcement.

Announcement #1 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university event.

The Community Outreach office is launching this semester's campus recycling challenge starting next Monday. Residence halls will compete to see who can collect the most recyclable materials over four weeks. The winning hall will receive a group pizza party. Check the university website for guidelines and weekly progress updates.

Announcement #2

21. B
The speaker tells members to "*review your assigned debate topics before each session*." This instruction helps them prepare for practice, so option B fits directly. Option A is incorrect because meeting the president isn't required. Option C is something debaters might do, but it's never stated. Option D adds unrelated information about tournament dates.

22. D
The mention of *"refining rebuttals and timing*" explains what the upcoming sessions will emphasize. It shows the focus of practice, not travel plans or event rules. Options A, B, and C all change the purpose of the statement; none of them match the speaker's intent.

Announcement #2 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

Hi everyone. Before we finish, I'd like to go over our updated practice schedule for the upcoming regional debate tournament. Starting next week, we'll meet every Tuesday and Thursday evening from 5 to 7 p.m. in Room 214. Please review your assigned debate topics before each session so we can focus on refining rebuttals and timing.

Announcement #3

23. A
The speaker tells students to "*check the posted schedule to see your assigned days*," which means students are encouraged to find out when they rehearse. Option B doesn't fit because no one is asked to submit measurements. Option C is unrelated; stage setup isn't mentioned. Option D sounds similar but refers to a website, which the speaker never mentions.

24. D
The speaker brings up costume fittings to make sure students attend their specific session the following week. It's a reminder, not an announcement about design or location. Options A, B, and C all invent details that aren't part of the message.

Announcement #3 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

Just a quick note for everyone involved in this semester's play. Rehearsals will begin next Monday at 6 p.m. in the Black Box Theater. Please check the posted schedule to see your assigned days. Costume fittings will take place the following week, so be sure to attend your designated session.

Announcement #4

25. B
Students are told that "*appointments fill up quickly*" and should therefore "*book their sessions early.*" That advice clearly encourages early scheduling. Option A doesn't apply because essays aren't discussed in class, and option C misstates the process—students must book online, not by email. Option D reverses the meaning; it's the Writing Center, not students, extending hours.

26. C
When the speaker mentions "*essays and citation formatting*," it serves as an example of the help tutors offer. The goal is to show what kind of assistance students can expect. Option A is inaccurate—there's no mention of templates. Option B introduces a nonexistent course, and option D confuses tutoring services with policy changes.

Announcement #4 Transcript

Listen to an announcement on the university radio station.

Hi everyone. The Writing Center is extending its tutoring hours during midterms. Starting next week, appointments will be available until 8 p.m. Monday through Thursday. Tutors can help with essays and citation formatting. Appointments fill up quickly, so students are encouraged to book their sessions early through the Writing Center's website.

Listen to an Academic Talk #1

27. D
The lecture focuses on how desert plants survive despite extreme heat and limited water, explaining their structural and behavioral adaptations, such as water storage and dormancy. This makes D the best answer. Option A focuses on agriculture, which is never mentioned. Option B centers on animals rather than plants. Option C explains desert formation, not adaptation.

28. A
The cactus survives by storing water in its thick stem and minimizing loss through its spines, which also protect it from animals. That clear two-part mechanism directly matches the passage. Option B introduces deep roots, which are not mentioned. Option C and D describe features—flat leaves and dew collection—that are never attributed to cacti in the lecture.

29. C
The professor emphasizes that desert plants have evolved intricate ways to handle drought, showing that even in harsh conditions, life adapts creatively. Option A is incorrect because irrigation systems are not part of natural adaptation. Option B misrepresents deserts as barren, which the talk disproves. Option D claims evolution has stopped, which contradicts the idea of continuing adaptation.

30. D
Engineers study desert plants to design new water-efficient technologies, such as materials that mimic how plants conserve moisture. The mention of engineers serves as a bridge between biology and applied science. Option A and B misstate the purpose of the research, and C brings up renewable energy, which is unrelated to the passage's focus.

Listen to an Academic Talk #1 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a biology class.

Surviving in a desert requires remarkable strategies. In places where rainfall is rare and temperatures soar, plants have evolved specialized features that allow them to store water, reduce evaporation, and endure long periods of drought. One of the most familiar examples is the cactus. Its thick, fleshy stem acts as a reservoir, storing water collected during brief rains. The leaves have evolved into spines that protect the plant from animals while also reducing surface area, which limits water loss.

Another adaptation is timing. Many desert plants remain dormant for months, waiting for a short burst of rain before sprouting leaves and flowers. Seeds may lie buried for years until just the right conditions trigger germination. Some plants, like the creosote bush, release chemicals into the soil that prevent other plants from growing too close, conserving limited moisture for themselves. These strategies reveal how even in extreme environments, life finds a way to balance scarcity and growth.

Scientists studying desert ecosystems have discovered that these plants also influence local climates by stabilizing soil and reducing erosion. Their survival strategies inspire engineers developing materials and technologies designed to conserve water in dry regions. In the next part of this lecture, we'll explore how similar adaptations appear in desert animals and what they reveal about the limits of life on Earth.

Module 2: Answer Key

Listen and Choose #2

31. C, *I'll swing by the store on my way in.*
C is correct because it volunteers to handle the task, addressing the request directly. The other responses add details but don't agree to help.

Can someone pick up the snacks for the meeting?

32. D, *On your desk, right next to the printer.*
D is correct because it specifies the location of the report copies clearly and concisely. The other choices are unrelated or incomplete.

Where did you put the extra copies of the report?

33. C, *At nine thirty, but I plan to arrive early.*
C is correct because it answers the question precisely and adds a natural follow-up detail. The other options give general information about trains without addressing the question.

What time does your train leave tomorrow?

Conversation #3

34. C
The woman says she's "*visiting this weekend to see what it's like*," meaning she wants to learn more before signing up. Option A is wrong because no orientation is mentioned. Option B doesn't fit since she isn't adopting a pet. Option D adds new information about supplies that isn't in the passage.

35. D
She describes the volunteer work herself: "*Mostly walking dogs and helping clean the play area*." That matches option D exactly. The other tasks involve fundraising, training, or paperwork—none of which she mentions.

Conversation #3 Transcript

Woman: I'm thinking about signing up to volunteer at the animal shelter.
Man: That's nice. What kind of work would you be doing there?
Woman: Mostly walking dogs and helping clean the play area. I've never volunteered before, but it seems like a good way to spend a few hours each week.
Man: Definitely. My cousin did that and said it was rewarding.
Woman: I hope so. I'm visiting this weekend to see what it's like.

Conversation #4

36. D
The woman tells the man that "*the popular sessions fill quickly*," so she advises him to register right away. Her concern is about availability, not cost or schedule changes. Options A, B, and C all introduce details absent from the conversation.

37. A
The man replies, "*Good idea. I'll also check if the school provides transportation*." His first step is clearly to register that evening. Option B is close, but reviewing workshops comes after registration in the dialogue. Options C and D don't match what he plans to do.

Conversation #4 Transcript

Man: Are you going to the student leadership conference next month?
Woman: Yes, I registered last week, but I still need to confirm which workshops I want to attend.
Man: I haven't even signed up yet. Do you know if spots are still open?
Woman: Probably, but the popular sessions fill quickly. I'd register tonight if I were you.
Man: Good idea. I'll also check if the school provides transportation.
Woman: They do, but you have to reserve a seat on the shuttle in advance.

Listen to an Academic Talk #2

38. D
The student experiment showed that those who slept after studying remembered significantly more than those who stayed awake. Sleep helped consolidate what they learned into long-term memory. Option A is wrong because the study didn't focus on naps. Option B contradicts the results, and option C invents a group that studied in the morning, which wasn't part of the design.

39. C
The rats are mentioned to show that sleep's memory-strengthening effects occur across species, not just in humans. This comparison strengthens the point that sleep serves a universal biological role. Option A misinterprets the purpose of the example, Option B incorrectly discusses the duration of sleep, and Option D focuses on problem-solving rather than memory.

40. B
From the experiment's results, we can infer that sleep gives the brain time to organize and strengthen new information. It's not just rest—it's active processing. Option A implies conscious studying during sleep, which is impossible. Option C confuses sleep with avoidance of distraction. Option D is incorrect because sleep supports practice rather than replacing it.

41. A
The final sentence points directly to brain imaging and its potential for treating sleep disorders. That continuation makes A the clear choice. Option B downplays sleep entirely, Option C introduces caffeine—off-topic—and Option D shifts the focus to culture, which the professor doesn't mention.

Listen to an Academic Talk #2 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a physiology class.

Sleep is one of the body's most vital yet mysterious processes. For centuries, it was thought to be a period of complete rest, but modern research shows that the brain remains surprisingly active. During sleep, it processes memories, restores energy, and performs maintenance that waking life does not allow.

A series of studies with students has helped scientists understand this function more clearly. In one experiment, two groups were asked to learn a set of word pairs. One group studied in the evening and slept afterward, while the other stayed awake overnight. The next day, the group that had slept remembered far more. Brain scans showed that during deep sleep, areas involved in memory replayed patterns of activity seen during learning. This replay strengthened the connections between nerve cells, effectively transferring short-term information into long-term storage.

Researchers have observed similar effects in animals. When rats navigate a maze and then fall asleep, their brains repeat the same electrical patterns seen during exploration, as if practicing the route. These findings suggest that sleep acts as a kind of rehearsal, turning daily experience into lasting knowledge.
Despite its importance, sleep remains fragile in modern life. Bright screens, irregular schedules, and stress all interfere with its natural rhythm. Next, we'll discuss how scientists are using brain imaging to study what happens in the mind during each stage of sleep and how this research could help treat sleep disorders.

Listen to an Academic Talk #3

42. D
The lecture explains why cities are hotter than rural areas and what consequences result from that difference, such as higher energy use and smog. It also describes efforts to cool cities. All of that fits D perfectly. Option A focuses only on pollution, Option B narrows the topic to design, and Option C lists solutions rather than summarizing the entire idea.

43. B
Pavement and brick store heat during the day and release it slowly at night, keeping cities warm after sunset. That's the key mechanism behind the "*urban heat island*" effect. Option A adds details about trapped heat that weren't mentioned. Option C describes air movement but not heat storage. Option D incorrectly claims those surfaces reflect light when the problem is that they absorb it.

44. D
Los Angeles is used as a real-world example of how cities can reduce heat through reflective surfaces and light-colored road coatings. The example grounds theory in practice. Options A and B shift focus to global warming and pollution more generally, while C describes comparison rather than application.

45. B
The passage clearly implies that city design can influence climate—by choosing materials, vegetation, and layout, planners can control local temperature. Option A contradicts this by saying design doesn't matter. Option C misapplies the lesson to rural areas, and D focuses on regulation rather than planning, which isn't the point the professor makes.

Listen to an Academic Talk #3 Transcript

Listen to a talk in an ecology class.

In large metropolitan areas, temperatures often rise several degrees higher than in nearby rural regions. This pattern, known as the urban heat island effect, occurs when natural landscapes are replaced with surfaces that trap and store heat. Pavement, brick, and glass absorb sunlight throughout the day and release it slowly at night, preventing cities from cooling. Fewer trees and open spaces mean less shade and less evaporation, both of which normally keep temperatures down.
The consequences extend beyond simple discomfort. In hotter cities, residents consume more electricity for cooling, increasing greenhouse gas emissions. Air pollutants also react more quickly in warm air, worsening smog and respiratory problems. Urban planners have begun to address these problems by experimenting with reflective roofing materials and a new kind of park called a "pocket park," which lower neighborhood temperatures. In Los Angeles, for instance, a city program tested light colored road coatings and recorded surface temperatures several degrees lower than surrounding streets.

Such efforts demonstrate how small design choices can influence the broader urban climate. Researchers studying these initiatives are now asking which combinations of vegetation, building materials, and public policies can produce the most sustainable results in rapidly growing cities.

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Practice Test #2
For the TOEFL®
Speaking Section

The TOEFL Speaking Section:
Directions

In the speaking section, you will answer 11 questions to demonstrate how well you can speak English. There are two types of tasks.

Type of Task	Description
Listen and Repeat	Listen and repeat what you heard.
Take an Interview	Answer questions from the interviewer.

When you see the audio icon, it means that there is an audio passage you must listen to. Please click the icon to get redirected to the audio file. On test day, you may listen to each audio only once, and you will NOT be able to return to previous questions.

If you would like to read and listen to a sample response to the question you are answering, you can refer to the answer key.

Listen and Repeat

Directions: You will listen as someone speaks to you. Listen carefully and then repeat what you have heard. Depending on the length of the statement, you will have 8 to 12 seconds to repeat the statement. On test day, no time for preparation will be provided.

When you are ready, continue to the next page to start.

**Note that when practicing at home, you may use speech-to-text software to check the accuracy of your statements.*

You are being trained to guide new members at the fitness center.

1. Listen and repeat only once.

2. Listen and repeat only once.

3. Listen and repeat only once.

4. Listen and repeat only once.

5. Listen and repeat only once.

6. Listen and repeat only once.

7. Listen and repeat only once.

Take an Interview

Directions: On test day, you will be asked four questions and have 45 seconds to respond to each. You will not be given any time to prepare. Please answer the interviewer's questions.

You have agreed to participate in a research study about international education. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

1.
Please speak for up to 45 seconds after the question has been read.

2.
Please speak for up to 45 seconds after the question has been read.

3.
Please speak for up to 45 seconds after the question has been read.

4.
Please speak for up to 45 seconds after the question has been read.

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Practice Test #2

For the TOEFL® Speaking Section

Answer Key

Listen and Repeat

1. *Welcome to our modern fitness center.*

2. *The treadmills are located beside the windows.*

3. *The weightlifting area includes benches and dumbbells.*

4. *Please wipe each machine after finishing your workout.*

5. *Yoga mats and resistance bands are available near the wall.*

6. *For everyone's safety, avoid blocking the walkways with personal items.*

7. *Before leaving, return all equipment to its proper place so others can use it.*

Take an Interview

1. *I appreciate you taking the time to talk with me. Have you ever studied abroad, or do you know someone who has? What kind of experience did they have?*

Sample Answer

Yeah, actually, one of my closest friends, Minji, studied in Canada last year. She went to the University of British Columbia for a semester, and she absolutely loved it. She said the classes were smaller, and professors encouraged students to share their opinions, which was different from what we're used to in Korea. She also mentioned how friendly people were. Like, strangers would hold doors open or start small talk on the bus. It was much easier for her to meet new people and make friends than she had expected. It wasn't always easy, though; she said the first month felt really lonely. But by the end, she didn't want to come back because she'd made so many international friends and felt more independent.

2. *Thanks for sharing that. If you had the opportunity, would you prefer to study abroad for a full degree program that would take more than two years, or just a short-term exchange? Why?*

Sample Answer

If I had the choice, I'd probably go for a short-term exchange, maybe one year at most. I think that's enough time to experience life in another country without feeling like I'm completely starting over. It is hard for me to imagine living in another country for years. A full degree abroad sounds exciting, but it's also expensive and far from family. I'm really close to my parents, and honestly, I think I'd miss home too much after a while. My cousin studied in the U.S. for four years, and she said the homesickness hit her hard around the second year. I really can't imagine being away from my friends, family, and culture for too long. So for me, a one-year exchange would be perfect.

3. *That's interesting. Many students now take online courses from foreign universities instead of traveling overseas. Do you think virtual programs will replace in-person study abroad in the future? Why or why not?*

Sample Answer

Hmm, that's an interesting question. Well, to be honest, I don't think so—not completely, at least. Online courses are great for saving money and time, but they can't really replace the real experience of living abroad. When you're physically there, you have to speak the language every day, try new food, and deal with cultural surprises. That's what actually changes you. During COVID, I took an online summer course from a U.S. university, and it was interesting, but it didn't feel like I was part of the community. I never met my classmates, and the discussions were kind of quiet. So, virtual programs will grow, but I think people will still want that face-to-face, real-life experience.

4. *Let me finish with this: some people believe studying abroad helps you understand other cultures, while others think it's more about improving career opportunities. Which do you agree with, and why?*

Sample Answer

That's a good question. I'd say it's mainly about understanding other cultures. Of course, it looks good on your resume, but the real value comes from how it changes the way you see the world. My friend Minji told me that after living in Canada, she became more open-minded and confident talking to people from different backgrounds. When she came back to Korea, she wasn't as shy as she used to be and was much more willing to talk to strangers and take risks. I think experiences like my friend's time abroad shape your personality more than any class or internship. Career benefits are nice, but the personal growth—that feeling of seeing life from another perspective—is what really lasts.

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Practice Test #2
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Writing Section

The TOEFL Writing Section:
Directions

In the writing section, you will answer 12 questions to demonstrate how well you can write in English. There are three types of tasks.

Type of Task	Description
Build a Sentence	Create a grammatical sentence.
Write an Email	Write an email using the information provided.
Write for an Academic Discussion	Participate in an online discussion.

On test day, you will have 6 minutes to complete the Build a Sentence tasks, 7 minutes to complete Write an Email task, and 10 minutes to complete the Write for an Academic Discussion task.

On test day, there is no spellcheck.

If you would like to see a model response for the Write and Email task or for the Write for an Academic Discussion task, you can refer to the answer key.

Build a Sentence

Directions: Move the words or phrases to the blanks to create grammatical sentences. On test day, you will have 6 minutes to complete 10 questions.

1.

Why did you miss the bus this morning?

____ ____ ____ on time ____ ____ ____ ____.

been / left / if / I / earlier / would / have arrived / I had

2.

I heard Ethan started a new job last month.

____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____?

me / offered / position / was / what / tell / you / he / can

3.

Why did your team miss the submission deadline?

____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____.

couldn't / the file / upload / servers / crashed / because / the website / we

4.

The professor announced there will be a field trip next week.

Has she explained ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____?

doing / be / on time / the / students / what / will / there

5.

Are you planning to attend the international fair this year?

____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ other countries.

students / forward / looking / from / meeting / to / and / I'm

6.

What are the organizers planning for the festival?

____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ .

plan / to perform / they / musicians / stage / to invite / local / the / for

7.

The manager asked about our travel plans for next week.

He ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ early flight.

wanted / if / had / we / to know / an / booked / yet

8.

What kind of movie do you usually like to watch?

____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____?

are / theaters / true stories / prefer / I / based on / that / films

9.

Which team won the championship this year?

____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ended up winning.

the / that / trained / team / the / hardest / match / year

10.

Did the professor explain the homework clearly?

He didn't ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____ ____.

over / go / the / few / last / sometimes / questions / in detail

Write an Email

You recently joined the campus photography club because you are eager to improve your skills and participate in events. Unfortunately, you missed the last meeting due to a scheduling conflict with a lab session. You would like to find out what you missed. Write an email to the club president, Ms. Patel. In your email, do the following: • Explain why you missed the meeting. • Ask what was discussed or decided at the meeting. • Offer to help with any upcoming club activities. Write as much as you can and in complete sentences.	Your Response: To: Ms. Patel Subject: Missed photography club meeting *Space for typing answers. On test day, you will have 7 minutes to read and write.*

Write for an Academic Discussion

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Franklin

Next, we'll be discussing the future of work, focusing specifically on digital nomadism and its impact on traditional work cultures. This concept allows individuals to work remotely from various locations around the world, using technology to perform their jobs. It raises important questions about productivity and work-life balance. Do you believe that digital nomadism positively impacts work cultures? Why or why not?

Alice

I think digital nomadism is beneficial. It offers flexibility and autonomy, allowing people to design their work schedules around their lives rather than vice versa. This flexibility can lead to increased job satisfaction and productivity as people work in environments where they feel most comfortable.

Bob

While Alice highlights some valid points, I'm skeptical about the overall impact. This lifestyle can blur the lines between work and personal life, potentially leading to burnout. Furthermore, remote working can sometimes hinder team cohesion and company culture, aspects that are crucial for organizational success.

Space for typing answers. On test day, you will have 10 minutes to read and write.

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Practice Test #2
For the TOEFL® Writing Section
Answer Key

Build a Sentence

1. *I would have arrived on time if I had left earlier.*

2. *Can you tell me what position he was offered?*

3. *We couldn't upload the file because the website crashed.*

4. *Has she explained what the students will be doing there?*

5. *I'm looking forward to meeting students from other countries.*

6. *They plan to invite local musicians to perform.*

7. *He wanted to know if we had booked an early flight.*

8. *I prefer films that are based on true stories.*

9. *The team that trained the hardest ended up winning.*

10. *He didn't go over the last few questions in detail.*

Write an Email - Sample Response

Dear Ms. Patel,

As you probably noticed, I wasn't present at last week's photography club meeting. Unfortunately, it was held at the same time as a mandatory lab session for one of my chemistry classes. Could you possibly let me know what was discussed at the meeting, or if the members made any decisions about club activities for the upcoming year? If you are still looking for volunteers to assist with those activities, I will be very happy to help. Once midterm exams are finished, I will have plenty of time to dedicate to extracurriculars. I'll arrive at next week's meeting a little bit early, so we can discuss this issue in person, if you prefer.

Thanks,
Jane Alderman

Write for an Academic Discussion - Sample Response

"Do you believe that digital nomadism positively impacts work cultures? Why or why not?"

Digital nomadism offers a unique advantage by providing freedom and flexibility that boost productivity. I have worked from different locations while traveling and noticed that choosing the right environment helps me focus better on my tasks. I learned to set clear work hours during a semester abroad, which made it easier to enjoy new experiences without losing concentration on my studies. I understand Bob's concern that this lifestyle might blur the boundaries between work and personal time. However, I found that sticking to a strict schedule can help prevent burnout while still enjoying the benefits of working remotely. For example, when I worked from a quiet café in a small town, I was able to meet my deadlines and still have time to explore the local culture.

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